

Brandon Alexander Blake

Phone: (407)780-1572 | Email: brandonablake0529@gmail.com

SUMMARY

Dynamic, agile inventory management and supply chain leader with more than 8 years of experience in building categories, managing, and developing talent, maintaining stakeholder value, and delivering outcomes that drive revenue, growth, brand visibility, and organizational success. Collaborative and skilled at engaging partners; innovative with a capacity to supply meaningful insights through strategy, analytics, and data curation and visualization.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Victoria's Secret, Corporation

Columbus, OH

Operations Planner, PINK and VS Brands (Contract)

November 2025 - Present

Own end-to-end order management process for Victoria's Secret's Accessories division in PINK and VS brands

- Manage On-Order Reporting for 26 vendors for both brands, making purchase order callouts and resolutions
 - ❖ Make shifts to GAC dates in SAP based on vendors' viability of completing orders within commit date
 - ❖ Communicate pricing changes with cross-functional Production Planning team; update approved changes in SAP
 - ❖ Update factory allocation for specified purchase orders in Salesforce
- Track compromised and late assortment items; inform Production Planning, Inventory Planning, and Allocation/Demand and Deployment teams of lateness and propose expedition alternatives where viable
- Control article creation, upload and maintenance of purchase orders, issue resolution in conjunction with offshore team
- Manage liability reporting for brands and manage tactical systems work for cancellation orders initiated by internal teams and/or vendors

RG Barry Brands

Pickerington, OH

Demand Planner

February 2025 – October 2025

Built, maintained, and refined trend-based forecasts for 7 wholesale accounts for RG Barry Brand's Footwear division

- Developed robust forecasts for 7 direct-to-consumer (DTC) and business-to-business (B2B) wholesale accounts, totaling to \$20 million in annual revenue for made-to-order (MTO) and made-to-forecast (MTF) character choices
- Partnered cross-functionally with Sales and Supply Planning, aligning on demand assumptions and supply orders
 - ❖ Confirmed status of materials on-hand and ensured quantities met existing and future demand satisfactorily
 - ❖ Raised awareness around geo-diversity and factory allocation efforts; made callouts for potential lateness due to orders being placed outside of required order horizon
- Produced and maintained key performance metrics such as forecast accuracy, bias, and inventory turns
 - ❖ Executed month-over-month review of side-by-side and business forecast; track forecast accuracy and stability
 - ❖ Completed month-end analyses, highlighting causation for forecast shifts; illustrated forecast beats/misses to plan by revenue and units for each account
- Performed root-cause analysis over data systems and planning tools feeding into forecast
 - ❖ Audited Excel planning tools for enhancement opportunities; verified formula efficacy and data integrity
 - ❖ Collaborated with Sales and Account Support to ensure external customers' inventory feeds for are active; ensured correct SKUS/character choices are listed for D2C-dropship accounts

Big Lots, Inc.

Columbus, Ohio

Senior Allocation Analyst

November 2023 – February 2025

Delivered tactical inventory deployment strategy to drive success for Big Lots' Decorative Textiles and Bath departments

- Developed pre-season unit demand forecasts by using SKU Optimization Report to guide Planning and Merchants
 - ❖ Utilized report to perform volume band and alpha grade analysis at class, SKU, and/or item levels
 - ❖ Assess performance by volume band and region to determine viability of all-store buy and wedged buy SKUs
- Collaborated with Buying, Planning, Merchandising, and Replenishment cross-functional teams to align on business nuances, inventory challenges, end-to-end allocation strategies, and end-of-life inventory disposition objectives
 - ❖ Discussed successes and opportunities within business categories; proposed immediate solutions for missed plans
 - ❖ Affected sales by exceeding multi-million-dollar weekly allocation goals through inventory prioritization and disposition of seasonal product, promotional sales items, and marketing events/activities
- Mitigated allocation depth by making callouts for SKUs received in incorrect case pack configurations
 - ❖ Created Excel tool to quantify total units and value of SKUs unavailable to allocate due to misconfiguration
 - ❖ Determined viability of having case pack configurations right-sized; direct VAS to correct receipts
- Served as divisional subject matter expert to train junior analysts; led initiatives to enhance reporting processes

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WORK EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

The Gap, Inc.

Washington, D.C. (Remote)

Inventory Planner, Banana Republic Factory Stores Division

November 2020 – May 2023

Set pre-season strategies and built assortment architecture plans to support merchant's vision and align with organizational financial goals for Banana Republic Factory Stores' Women's and Petites ready-to-wear categories

- Developed plans by managing open-to-buy targets at department, class, subclass, and key item levels
 - ❖ Identified opportunities to promote lift in activity and identified risks with negative, downstream impacts
- Led monthly New Flow Alignment meetings to communicate logistical issues for inbound/outbound POs
 - ❖ Tracked purchase order milestone and modified plans for key commercial programs and big buys
 - ❖ Proposed fungible transfers and fulfillment for compromised assortment and short-shipped purchase orders
- Observed category success for seasonal and never-out/core items to provide insights for future strategy
- Streamlined processes by creating universal, standardized tools to assist in operating procedures
 - ❖ Created template to track completion of new flow assortment allocation at hierarchical levels and by domestic (US) and international market (Europe and Canada)

Williams-Sonoma, Inc.

San Francisco, California

Distribution Planner, Pottery Barn Kids Division

November 2019 – May 2020

Optimized assortment of specialty goods for 66 retail stores and e-commerce channel for Furniture and Textiles divisions

- Worked with external partners to ensure appropriate lead times and OTIF deliveries for more than 100 SKUs from vendors to warehouse distribution centers to 62 USA and 4 Canada retail stores
 - ❖ Briefed Distribution and Retail teams on impacts of the Suez Canal closure during the COVID-19 pandemic; selected fungible inventory transfers to replace late receipts, improve store in-stock rates, and inventory turns
- Managed fulfillment with vendors to provide replenishment to stores with exceptional inventory needs and sales
 - ❖ Proposed PO expedition for programs with increased sales performance and demonstrable replenishment needs
- Directed meeting with Inventory Planning and Merchant Planning teams to address inventory challenges and sales disparities between brick-and-mortar retail stores and omni channel
 - ❖ Mitigated end-of-season inventory overstock and liability by balancing liable units between retail stores and online sales channels to improve assortment ownership, sell-thru, and profitability
- Provided weekly interpretation of category performance and incidents impacting retail sales goals and strategies

Ross Stores, Inc.

Dublin, California

Allocation Analyst, Ross Stores Division

August 2017 – November 2019

Enhanced visibility of off-price goods through targeted product allocation for Ross Stores' Bed and Bath division

- Implemented process improvements by creating allocation parameters, ensuring 95% auto-allocation in categories
 - ❖ Set tiered allocation min-max constraints in APX by reviewing on-order report with inbound unit quantities
 - ❖ Reviewed assortment penetration to establish user-defined attribute driver in APX to create breadth of assortment
- Researched SKU and category-level callouts to identify business shortfalls and improve month-to-month plan achievement; created PowerPoint presentation to report findings to leadership and key stakeholders
 - ❖ Used data analytics to conduct deep dive analyses to report KPIs and business inefficiencies
 - ❖ Aggregated and scaled large data into succinct business review dashboards with actionable, go-forward strategies
- Increased sell-thru, and inventory turn by identifying specialized opportunities to support treasure hunt philosophy
 - ❖ Created cluster strategies, specialty store groups, and distribution lists to allocate inventory to optimal stores
- Served as development partner for new Assortment Associates, ensuring junior team members developed competencies in allocation strategy and proficiency with department systems and tools

COMPETENCIES

KEY SKILLS:

Wholesale Planning | Allocation and Replenishment | Forecasting
Fulfillment and Distribution Data Analytics | Supply Chain Optimization | Logistics

SYSTEMS:

Power BI | Retail Data Warehouse (RDW) | MicroStrategy | Sigma | Salesforce
JDA Allocation/Blue Yonder | Retek Allocation | PETE Allocation Systems | SAM-Logility
Centric PLM | APX | Clarity Production | SAP | AS400-Donald Systems | O9 | Excel

EDUCATION

Norfolk State University, Norfolk, Virginia

January 2009 – May 2013

Bachelor of Science (Hons): Business Commerce, Finance Concentration